

Literature review toolkit

One package for imports, screening, classification, evidence extraction and synthesis.

Toolkit developed with assistance from GPT-6 Astra. This guide and the accompanying documentation were generated by GPT-6 Astra.

Start with your review question and search exports. The toolkit keeps the records together, helps you retrieve and read the PDFs, and turns your saved choices into searchable tables and maps.

Start here: extract the ZIP, run **Setup.cmd** once, then **Start review.cmd**. The launcher opens your default browser. Project settings are entered on the page; no terminal questionnaire is needed.

New review templates contain no papers, decisions or subject-specific labels. You define the scheme. A prepared corpus, if supplied, is a separate project. All screenshots in this guide were captured from this release; search, screening and synthesis use the same visual style.

Find your next step

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Search & screen	Classify & extract	Compare & write
Database files, eligibility decisions, PDFs and citation chasing.	Independent category labels, domains, source passages and your evidence choices.	Charts and matrices link every count back to its papers.

Install once, then use the browser

Windows quick start. Python 3.10 or newer is required.

1. Extract the ZIP

Use a normal local folder, for example C:/Research/ReviewToolkit. Do not launch the scripts from inside the ZIP. Keep your original PDFs separately.

2. Run Setup.cmd

Install Python first if it is missing. Setup.cmd creates a .venv folder and installs the PDF parsers and requests package. This installation uses the internet.

If Windows cannot find a working Python 3.10 or newer, install it from python.org and run Setup.cmd again. Setup repairs an invalid .venv by saving it as a backup and creating a new one. Do not copy .venv between computers.

3. Run Start review.cmd

Your default browser opens the setup page. Leave the launcher process running while using setup. All project questions are in the HTML interface.

What is inside the folder

```
Start review.cmd
Setup.cmd
workflow.py
toolkit.py
toolkit/
projects/_template/
Literature review toolkit - complete guide.pdf
```

The default installation has no model connector. numpy and scikit-learn are listed separately for the optional earlier title-screening backcheck; they are not needed for the main workflow.

On macOS/Linux, create a virtual environment, install requirements.txt and run python workflow.py. The Windows .cmd launchers do not apply. This release was tested on Windows; other operating systems were not tested.

Choose where your review starts

Begin with a new search, existing metadata and PDFs, or your saved work.

Start a literature search

Expand Search & screening projects. Enter a review name and a short folder name, then choose Create search project.

Start with metadata and PDFs

Name the review, select your metadata CSV and PDF folder, and choose a new output folder. Then define categories, domains and evidence fields that fit your review question.

Continue saved work

Choose Open saved review and select the saved run folder. Keep its original source files available when checking or confirming records.

PROJECT & FILES

Choose your project and sources

Project name

Metadata CSV

PDF folder

Save new review inside

New review folder name

Example settings; choose your own files and folder.

Plan the search and save its exports

The toolkit processes database exports. You run and document the database searches yourself.

Before searching

Write the review question, eligibility criteria, databases, search strings, date range and language limits. Keep the rationale for any later change.

Use `search_log_template.csv` to record each database, query, search date, filters, result count and export filename.

Export useful metadata

Include title, authors, year, DOI and abstract where possible. Export all batches when a database limits downloads. Give each export a distinct name and preserve the original files.

Copy exports into the new project's `exports/` folder. Metadata exports and full-text PDFs are different inputs; exporting citations does not download the papers.

Supported import formats

Format	How to use it
BibTeX	Set format to <code>bibtex</code> . Common database BibTeX exports are supported.
IEEE-style CSV	Set format to <code>ieee_csv</code> . The importer recognises its common headings.
Other CSV	Set format to <code>csv</code> and map your column headings on the setup page.
RIS / EndNote XML	No direct parser is included. Export or convert to supported BibTeX/CSV first.

The toolkit does not log in to subscription databases or run Scopus/WoS/IEEE searches automatically.

Configure database imports on the page

Open the search project setup page and use its Database exports section.

File: give the path relative to the project, such as exports/scopus.bib. **Source label:** give the database name.

Format: use bibtex, ieve_csv or csv.

For a custom CSV, fill the column map as field=Column heading, one per line. Use semicolons for alternative headings. Match the headings in your file exactly.

Useful field names are title, authors, year, doi, journal, abstract and type. A missing title causes that row to be skipped. Compare imported counts with the export totals.

Abstract supplements can be registered separately. Save the settings before running import stages.

2 - Database exports

Put the files in `exports/` inside the project folder. Formats: `bibtex`, `ieeve_csv` or `csv` with a column map in project.json.

file (relative to project)	source label	format	CSV columns: field=heading (optional)
exports/database_a.bib	Database A	bibtex	
exports/database_b.csv	Database B	csv	title=title authors=authors

+ export

Abstract supplements (optional second exports with abstracts)

file	format
+ supplement	

The CSV mapping is editable in HTML and preserved when saving the project.

```
title=Article title
authors=Authors
year=Publication year
doi=DOI
abstract=Abstract
```

Define screening vocabulary and rules

Search screening uses ordered rules; the later category matcher has its own simpler term lists.

Vocabulary

Set population, technology/concept and context patterns for your question. Add exclusion patterns only when they identify a clear reason to reject a record.

These fields use Python regular expressions. For example, urban|city matches either word; parentheses group alternatives. Test patterns before processing the full export.

Ordered screening rules

Rules are checked from top to bottom. The first matching rule supplies Include, Maybe or Exclude and a reason. Keep an always -> Maybe fallback at the bottom.

Example: text:population & text:technology. Title-only conditions use title:pattern_name. Save project.json after testing.

The optional single-label taxonomy in the search setup page produces draft reports only. Configure new multi-label categories and domains in the combined review setup (pages 14-16). Do not treat the two schemes as interchangeable.

4 · Screening rules (evaluated in order; first match wins)

Condition syntax: title:population, abstract:x, text:x (title + abstract head), flags title_only, has_abstract, year_before_min, no_year, always; operators & | ! and parentheses. Reason may use {year} and {min_year}.

if (condition)	decision	code	reason	
year_before_min	Exclude	before_min_year	Before the selected year	x ↑ ↓
title:wrong_population	Exclude	wrong_population	Different setting	x ↑ ↓
text:population & text:technology	Include		Population and concept match	x ↑ ↓
always	Maybe	needs_review	Read before deciding	x ↑ ↓
+ rule				

A fictional example of ordered rules. The empty template initially sends everything to Maybe.

Merge exports and inspect duplicates

Run Merge exports, dedupe, draft screening from the search setup page.

Check the import

The stage combines exports, normalises metadata, finds duplicate candidates and creates stable record IDs. Inspect `title_screening.csv`, `corpus_deduped.csv` and the deduplication outputs.

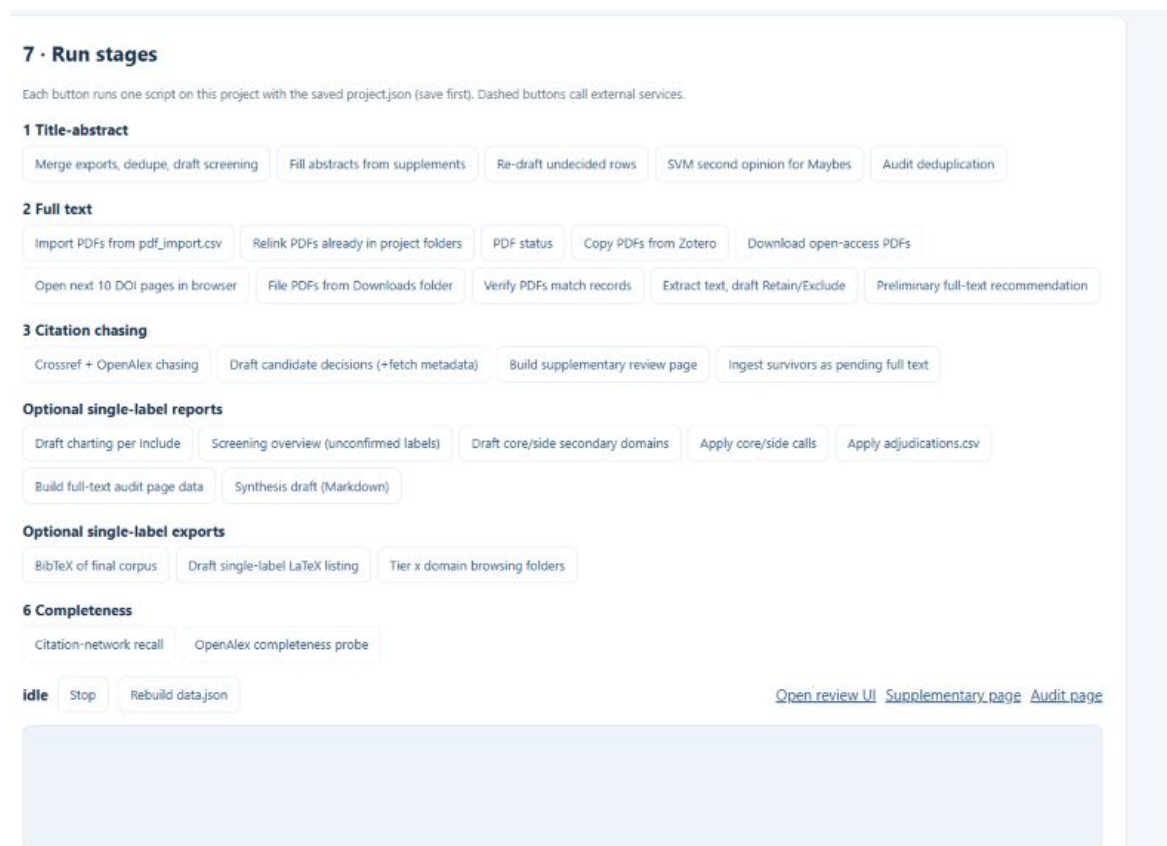
Compare the number of imported records with your search log. Investigate missing abstracts, empty titles, encoding problems and unexpected losses.

Check duplicate groups

DOI and normalised-title rules are useful, but they do not settle whether a conference paper, preprint and journal article are the same report. Use Audit deduplication and inspect ambiguous pairs yourself.

After screening starts

Use Re-draft undecided rows for revised rules. Avoid forcing a fresh merge into a reviewed project: record IDs and saved work need deliberate reconciliation. Back up first.



Run stages are available as buttons. Dashed buttons use external bibliographic or download services.

Screen titles and abstracts

Open Review UI after importing records. A script suggestion is a starting point for your decision.

Read, decide, save

Read each title and abstract, check your criteria, and choose Include, Maybe or Exclude individually. Include here means retrieve the full text, not final corpus inclusion. There is no bulk acceptance.

Add a short reason where needed. Use Review decided to revisit earlier calls. A missing abstract is a reason to investigate, not proof of ineligibility.

Press **S** or the save button to persist decisions to the project CSV. Browser state alone is not a complete backup.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
1 / 2 / 3	Include / Maybe / Exclude
J / K	Next / previous record
S	Save decisions

Urban street monitoring for heat decisions

— · 2024 · Database A;Database B

SCRIPT RECOMMENDATION

Include

Population and concept match

Abstract: "Fictional demonstration: urban heat monitoring, prediction and decision support for city planning"

Include 1

SCRIPT SUGGESTION

Population and concept match

Abstract: "Fictional demonstration: urban heat monitoring, prediction and decision support for city planning"

Maybe 2

Not the script suggestion

Exclude 3

Not the script suggestion

Exclusion code

—

Notes

Synthetic test decision only.

► Abstract & metadata

[Clear decision \(back to undecided\)](#)

Title/abstract screening view from the fictional test project.

Import PDFs with an explicit file map

The most predictable import route links each record ID to one local PDF.

1. Keep original PDFs

Store the downloaded papers in a source folder. The importer copies files into the project, preserving the originals.

2. Prepare pdf_import.csv

Use pdf_import_template.csv. Put the record_id from title_screening.csv beside its pdf_path. Paths can be absolute or relative to the mapping CSV.

3. Import and verify

Save the file as pdf_import.csv in the search project. Click **Import PDFs from pdf_import.csv** under Run stages.

Unknown/duplicate IDs, missing PDFs and conflicts with existing files stop the import. Then run Verify PDFs match records and inspect uncertain matches.

Example mapping

```
record_id, pdf_path
R0001, C:/Research/PDFs/paper-one.pdf
R0002, C:/Research/PDFs/paper-two.pdf
```

Where the copies go

Pending sources are stored under pdfs/01_not_reviewed/ using an ID-based filename. The PDF manifest records the linked copy.

If files are already inside the project, use Relink PDFs already in project folders. Use ID-prefixed names such as R0001__short-title.pdf so the mapping is unambiguous.

A filename or title match can still point to a supplement, wrong version or wrong paper. Verify the source before reviewing it.

Other PDF collection routes

Choose the route that fits your library. All resulting files still need an identity check.

Route	Preparation	Then run
Zotero	Set the Zotero storage path under project paths.	Copy PDFs from Zotero, then Verify PDFs match records.
Local download folder	Set one or more download_dirs in the search settings. Download papers yourself using your available access.	File PDFs from Downloads folder. Matching uses filenames/metadata; uncertain files need explicit mapping.
Open-access retrieval	Set a contact email for bibliographic providers. Review the configured source IDs.	Download open-access PDFs. This contacts Unpaywall/OpenAlex and the returned PDF hosts.
Publisher pages	Use the DOI-opening stage to open the next missing sources.	Download the appropriate PDF in your browser, then import or harvest it.
Existing project copies	Keep ID-based names in the project PDF folders.	Relink PDFs already in project folders, then verify.

Local imports copy their source files. Downloaded temporary files may be moved within the project. Excluding a paper in the screening interface can remove its project working copy; keep the original PDF folder and a project backup.

The tools do not bypass access restrictions. Optional provider services may require contact details, keys or updated settings; failed retrievals remain for manual handling.

Make full-text eligibility decisions

Read the paper before saving its final Include or Exclude decision.

Run **Extract text, draft Retain/Exclude**, then **Preliminary full-text recommendation**. The scripts extract local text and apply the configured rules.

Use Included report or Final corpus to open the source, inspect the recommendation and record your decision. Full-text eligibility is distinct from the categories you will assign later.

Missing files, scanned pages and poor extraction require direct PDF reading. No OCR is bundled. A negative or absent term match is not a scientific conclusion.

Save final decisions before transferring papers to the combined workspace. Undecided records remain in the search project.

Full-text decisions are not automatically confirmed from the draft. Save later changes as explicit decisions.

Decided

Left

6
Include

0
Maybe

2
Exclude

8
Total

100% decided

Screen new

Review decided

Included report

Screened Includes

Single-label report (optional)

Supplementary

Single-label edits (optional)

Project setup & run

Full-text audit

Full-text recommendations are draft assessments. They distinguish abstract-only evidence, available open-access links, and genuinely reviewed local PDFs.

6
retained for full-text screening

1 Retain

0 Needs verification

5 Exclude

0 OA links found · 0 local PDF reviewed · final: 6 Include, 0 Exclude

Domain counts overlap because papers may carry multiple tags.

Draft application domain

Unassigned

Domain

All domains

Technology tier

All technology tiers

Recommendation

All recommendations

Evidence

All evidence types

Search

R0006

1 of 6 retained papers shown

Record	Domain	Tier	Recommendation	Paper	Evidence / source
R0006	Unassigned	Unassigned	Retain Explicit decision/advisory element tied to a management variable or operation. ► Automated full-text analysis · automated_fulltext_analysis Final: Include Include Exclude	Street temperature observations and planning Example, A. · 2024	Automated full-text (human review pend OA discovery not run DOI

Current full-text view. Script suggestions and your final decisions are separate.

Current interface edition | Screenshots, 28 September 2026. Fictional demonstration papers.

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Extend the search with citation chasing

Optional metadata lookups find candidates; the reviewer still decides eligibility.

1. Find candidates

Run Crossref + OpenAlex chasing after you have full-text Includes with DOIs. It looks backward through references and forward through citing works, then checks candidates against the existing project.

Set `chase_population`, `chase_technology`, `language` and `year` criteria first. Blank topic patterns can leave no candidates.

2. Review the candidates

Run Draft candidate decisions, then Build supplementary review page. Open `supplementary_review.html` and inspect the candidate titles, abstracts and source links.

Export your decisions as `citation_chase_human_decisions.csv` into the project folder.

3. Bring Includes into full-text review

Run Ingest survivors as pending full text. It requires your exported decision file. Included candidates receive pending full-text records; they are not final corpus inclusions.

Collect their PDFs, assess full-text eligibility, then include them in the later transfer. Keep search-arm and source information.

Provider settings

Crossref metadata uses the configured contact details. Unpaywall requires an email parameter. For OpenAlex, an optional `OPENALEX_API_KEY` environment variable supplies a bearer token only to its HTTPS API.

API rules and limits can change. Consult the providers' current documentation if authentication or rate-limit errors appear. Chasing and completeness probes do not prove that all eligible literature was found.

Move included papers into the combined review

This connects search screening with multi-label classification, evidence and synthesis.

Return to Start review.cmd

On the browser home page expand Search & screening projects, select your saved project and click **Use included papers**.

Work through the category and form settings. Choose a new review folder. Check settings & files reports how many papers will be transferred.

Create & open review copies a settings snapshot and extracts the papers for the combined interface. Categories, domains and extraction fields start unconfirmed.

What the transfer checks

Check	Required state
Eligibility	Explicit full-text Include and title/abstract Include.
Identity	Unique record ID with matching metadata.
PDF	Existing local copy inside this project's PDF folder.
Destination	New run and settings filename; no overwrite.

Pending records are reported, not silently counted as included. A missing source or inconsistent decision blocks transfer. The timestamped transfer CSV and handoff.json retain the source IDs, counts and hashes.

If using CSV + PDFs directly, the file browser provides the same preparation route without a prior search project.

Configure categories and domains

Every label is independent. A paper can belong to more than one category or domain.

Click Add category and enter its name and definition. Add domains in the same way. The definitions guide your reading; scripts do not interpret them.

Open Script matching terms to supply phrases, optional required co-occurring terms and exclusions. One term per line or semicolons are accepted.

These term lists are literal, except a trailing * for word stems. Unlike the earlier screening vocabulary, they are not arbitrary regular expressions. Leave terms blank for manual assessment.

Passage safeguards can suppress background, future work, attribution and negation. The heuristics are English-oriented and need checking for other languages.

An absent match remains unresolved; it is not an automatic No. Changing category definitions after review starts requires a new run and explicit reconciliation.

categories At least one + Add category

Category 1 Remove

Label name

Monitoring

Definition / boundary

Measurements developed or evaluated in the study.

▼ Script matching terms - optional

Matching words or phrases

monitoring; sensors; measurement*

One per line or separate with semicolons. A final * matches a word stem. Leave empty for manual assessment.

Also require at least one of these terms

Suppress matches containing these terms

Browser controls for independent categories and domain definitions.

Design the evidence and synthesis form

Keep the measures few and clear. Every field and answer list is configurable.

Add a field and choose its title, group heading, answer format and answer choices. Use Choose one, Choose several or Free text.

Guidance should explain what counts as evidence for each choice. Mark fields required only when they must be assessed before confirmation.

Mark **Reviewer interpretation** for your synthesis judgments. Leave it off for fields recording source findings. These remain distinct during review.

Use Advanced field settings for stable IDs and choices that must stand alone. Select whether each field appears in the synthesis overview.

Domain synthesis notes are a separate optional set of headings or choices for comparing several papers. They do not create extra paper-level evidence.

Field 1 Remove

Display title: Testing and use

Group heading: Evidence

Answer format: Choose one

Answer choices:

- Concept / laboratory
- Field study
- Routine use

One choice per line. Use your own short, clear options.

Guidance shown while reviewing:

Choose the highest level supported by the study; record the supporting page.

☐ Required before confirmation ☐ Reviewer interpretation ☒ Show in synthesis overview

An example three-choice field configured in the browser; no fixed subject-specific form is bundled.

Set reading priorities and finish setup

Optional settings help organise the work without changing eligibility.

Reading priorities

Define ordered groups with Brief check or Detailed reading. A group can match CSV decision-link values, any selected category, or exactly a category set.

The first match wins. An empty-condition group catches remaining papers. Add selectable reasons for brief checks; required detailed groups cannot be marked brief-done.

If you do not need priorities, leave the groups empty. Every paper remains available for detailed extraction.

Section headings

Standard abstract and conclusion headings are detected by default. Custom section IDs, titles and headings can be configured for other conventions. Verify the resulting text boundaries.

Check and open

Download settings to reuse the scheme. Import settings reads a previous configuration without changing the original file.

Check settings & files validates the configuration, record IDs, local PDF paths and new output location. It does not judge the scientific quality of the sources.

Create & open review runs local PDF extraction and configured matching. Progress appears on the page, then the review opens automatically.

If preparation fails, read the displayed error. Fix the input and choose a new run name; incomplete or existing folders are not overwritten.

Review one paper, keep decisions distinct

Classification and evidence extraction share a page but have separate saved states.

Categories & domains

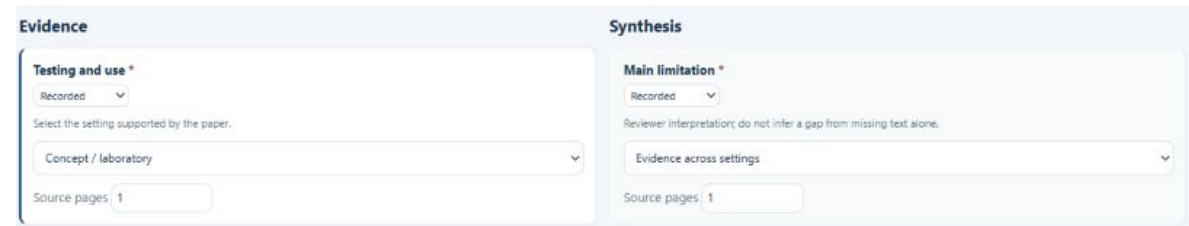
Read the supporting passages and source. Choose Yes, No or ? for every category. Choose Core, Secondary or Not assigned for each domain, then a primary core domain.

Confirm classification after checking the record. All No categories exclude the paper from the confirmed corpus. Extraction notes can still be retained.

Evidence & synthesis

Choose values in your form and record source support. Save draft or Later preserves unfinished work. Confirm & next completes the extraction entry.

Enter confirms when no input/control has focus. Ctrl+Enter (Cmd+Enter on Mac) also works from a field. Holding a key does not repeatedly confirm papers.



The screenshot displays two side-by-side form panels. The left panel, titled 'Evidence', contains a 'Testing and use' section with a 'Recorded' dropdown menu, a text input field for 'Select the setting supported by the paper.' (containing 'Concept / laboratory'), and a 'Source pages' input field with a value of '1'. The right panel, titled 'Synthesis', contains a 'Main limitation' section with a 'Recorded' dropdown menu, a text input field for 'Reviewer interpretation; do not infer a gap from missing text alone.' (containing 'Evidence across settings'), and a 'Source pages' input field with a value of '1'.

Example evidence fields. Your configured choices appear together for fast review.

Check abstracts, conclusions and source pages

Extracted text helps you navigate. The PDF remains the source to verify.

Expand Abstract and conclusions to see sections found by heading rules. Their page links open the corresponding PDF. The result can be missing, truncated or uncertain.

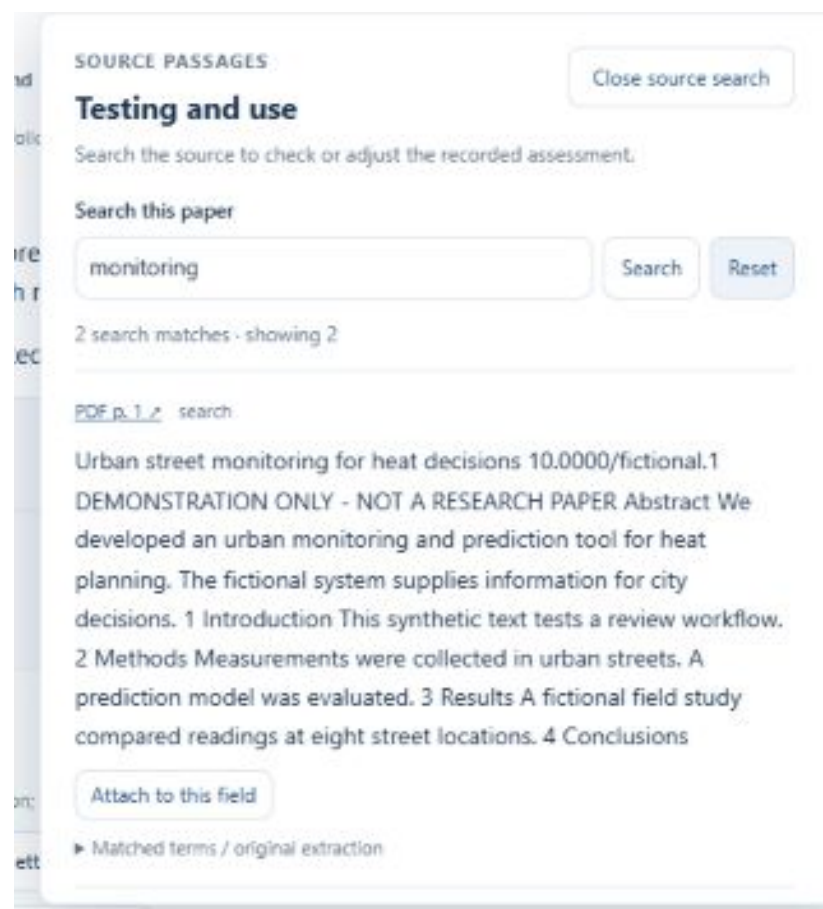
Use Open PDF for layout, figures and tables. Use local source search for terms you want to inspect; select a passage or record the relevant page yourself.

For required source-extraction fields, a recorded value needs supporting text or a page reference. Unclear and Not applicable stay separate from Not reported.

Do not infer absence from a blank field. Unchecked means no completed judgment has been saved.

Reviewer-interpretation fields record your synthesis separately.

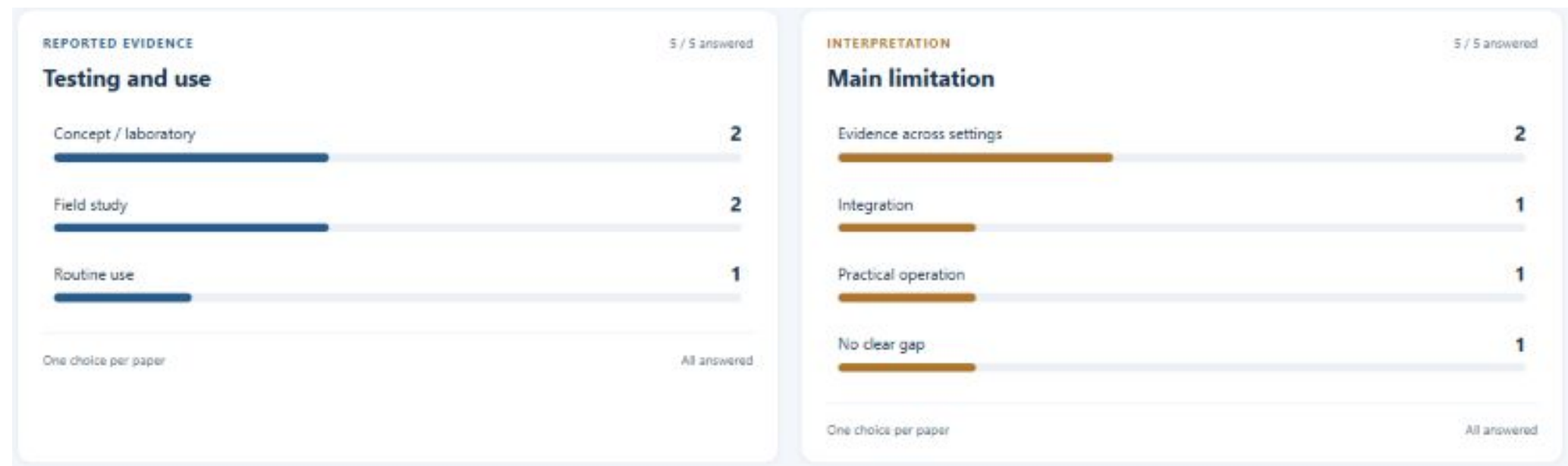
No model supplies the form values. The included pipeline extracts text, matches configured terms and stores the choices you save.



Local passage search with page references. The abstract/conclusion panels provide another route into the source.

Compare the evidence you have recorded

The synthesis view turns saved choices into an overview.



Bar summaries from a fictional demonstration review.

Choose the cohort first: assessed entries, drafts or all saved entries. Filter by category and core domain. Excluded papers are omitted from the default synthesis map.

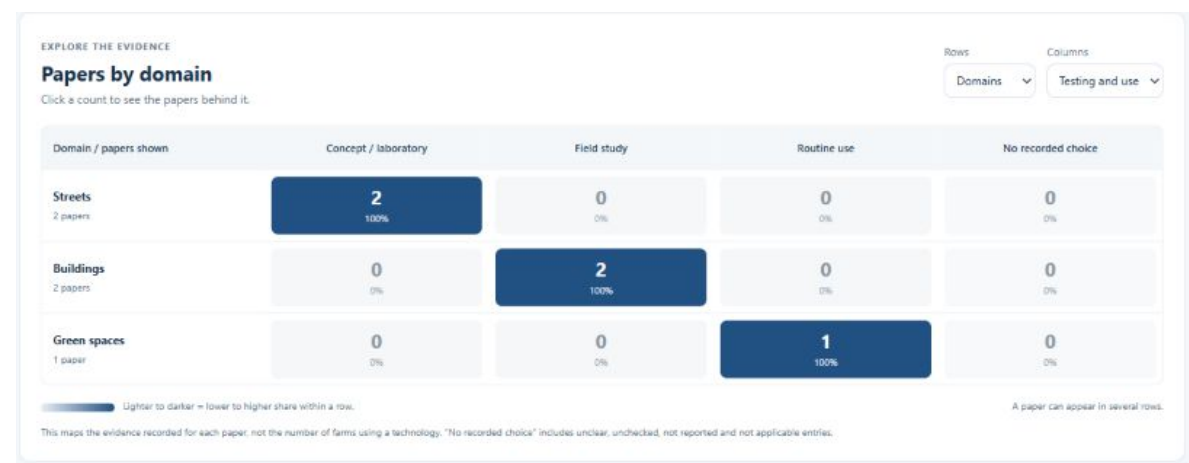
Read each chart as a count of saved choices in the selected papers. Drafts are not completed assessments.

Multiple labels and multiple-choice answers can overlap, so category totals need not add to the number of unique papers.

A missing choice is not a scientific result. Inspect the source papers behind a pattern before interpreting it.

Click a matrix cell to inspect its papers

Move between the summary and the evidence behind it.



Rows can be domains or categories; columns are the configured choice measure.

BEHIND THE NUMBERS
2 papers
Buildings - Testing and use: Field study

Clear selection Table columns All measures

Paper	Testing and use	Main limitation
R0002 - City heat prediction for cooling plans Prediction - Assessed	Field study Pages: 1	Integration Pages: 1
R0007 - Urban warning system for heat exposure Prediction - Assessed	Field study Pages: 1	Evidence across settings Pages: 1

A selected cell displays its matching paper list.

Choose a row dimension and a measure. Click a count to see the contributing records, then open an ID to return to that paper.

A paper can appear in several domain/category rows. Percentages use the selected row or cohort shown by the interface, not an unrelated whole-corpus denominator.

No recorded choice groups missing or unresolved field states for navigation. It does not mean the paper has no evidence.

Use domain notes to compare results, disagreement, conditions and remaining questions. A visual pattern is a starting point for synthesis, not a causal result.

Save, resume, export and back up

Keep the editable project and its sources, not just a summary table.

What you need	What to save or export
Resume search/screening	Keep the whole projects/<slug>/ folder, including project.json, raw exports, decision CSVs, PDF copies and caches.
Resume classification/evidence	Keep the entire run folder, its settings JSON, input CSV and original PDFs. Use Open saved review.
Analyse final labels	Use Export confirmed corpus CSV in the combined review. Every classification must be confirmed and current. Export unfinished classifications lists IDs and reasons when work remains.
Read the evidence map elsewhere	Use Export corpus explorer ZIP for the same paper and synthesis views, plus a summary CSV. The portable browser is read-only; see page 29.
Retain detailed notes and revisions	Use Export all review CSVs + history ZIP. It freezes journal writes while copying run records and settings. Keep source PDFs separately.
Move to another computer	Preserve source paths or deliberately relink/migrate them. Hash checks detect changed input files; do not remove them to hide a mismatch.

Settings are copied into each new run. Editing a template does not update an existing review. To change the schema after work starts, prepare a new run and reconcile earlier decisions explicitly.

Earlier screening reports are explicitly drafts (screening_corpus_draft.csv), not confirmed classification exports.
Back up your review data and source files separately.

Know which files belong to which stage

The two configurations have different jobs; the browser connects them.

Location	Purpose
projects/<slug>/project.json	Search exports, screening patterns/rules, paths, exclusions and optional earlier report settings.
title_screening.csv / corpus_deduped.csv	Imported records, rule suggestions and saved title/abstract decisions.
fulltext_recommendations.csv / fulltext_pdf_manifest.csv	Full-text suggestions, decisions and linked PDF copies.
<review>.project.json / manifest.csv	Multi-label/form settings and the run snapshot with source hashes.
papers/ / paper_sections/	CSV files of page text, detected sections and extraction warnings.
classification/catalog.csv / classification.csv	Category/domain proposals, saved decisions and their revision history.
extraction.csv / domain_notes.csv / reading.csv	Evidence, domain synthesis notes and optional reading-plan decisions.
handoff-inputs/ / handoff.json	Timestamped transfer CSVs and the checks linking an included cohort to its new run.

SCRIPT_INVENTORY.md describes the packaged scripts. PACKAGE_MANIFEST.json lists checksums. NETWORK_AND_MODEL_AUDIT.md distinguishes local processing from optional bibliographic calls.

Optional tools and command reference

Normal project setup uses HTML. Commands remain available for repeatable scripted work.

Search project commands

```
python toolkit.py init my-review "My review"
python toolkit.py serve my-review
python toolkit.py stages
python toolkit.py run merge_screen my-review
python toolkit.py run pdf_import my-review
python toolkit.py check my-review
```

Prepared review

```
python toolkit.py workspace
python toolkit.py workspace --run "C:/Research/run"
python handoff.py --project my-review --check
```

Optional earlier reports

The search module retains single-label charting and exports for existing workflows. Its draft tier/domain tables are not a substitute for the final multi-label workspace.

Optional SVM backcheck

backcheck_classifier.py is a local statistical text classifier for title/abstract suggestions. It uses earlier saved decisions and requires requirements-optional-ml.txt. It is not an LLM and is not run by the main category/extraction setup.

Scientific review remains yours

Rule matches, text extraction and visualisation do not establish source validity or classification accuracy. Check contribution, context, methods and the reported evidence yourself.

Troubleshooting and verification

Use the saved evidence and status messages to resolve problems; preserve your work first.

Problem	What to do
Browser did not open	Read the launcher message. Run Setup.cmd for a missing/broken environment or dependencies. If the server starts, open its printed local URL.
Missing PDF or wrong source	Check the CSV path and PDF root. Use explicit ID-to-PDF mapping; verify title, DOI and version.
Port busy	Browser setup selects a free port. For command-line launches, choose a different --port value.
Cannot confirm / revision changed	Complete required entries, resolve source warnings, then reload if another window saved newer work.
Setup fails during extraction	Read the error on the page. Keep the failed folder for inspection; fix the source and use a new run name.
Provider authentication or limit error	Check Crossref, OpenAlex or Unpaywall documentation. Local review does not depend on those lookups.
Blank or fragmented text	Read the PDF directly; scanned pages, columns and tables may not extract well. No OCR is bundled.

This release was checked with fictional papers: metadata import, duplicate merging, human decision persistence, PDF copies, protected transfers, browser project creation, configurable forms, responsive layout and existing review tests. No real research papers were used for those tests. CSV tests cover round-trip preservation, save conflicts, recovery and read-only legacy migration. Shared live views, exports and standalone CSV parsing were checked. Live bibliographic downloads were not exercised.

No local or external LLM runtime call was found in the packaged Python/JavaScript audit. Optional network stages use bibliographic providers or PDF hosts. This is a software review, not a legal certification of every source or a guarantee of scientific accuracy.

Screen reference: literature screening

Current toolkit. The queue, source information and eligibility choices remain together.

REVIEW & SYNTHESIS TOOLKIT

Developed with assistance from GPT-6 Astra.

Literature screening

Rules propose; you decide. Save decisions to the project CSV.
Project: Fictional urban-heat review

8
Decided

0
Left

6
Include

0
Maybe

2
Exclude

8
Total

100% decided

Screen new

Review decided

Included report

Screened Includes

Single-label report (optional)

R0001 B. include Script → Include You: Include has abstract

Urban street monitoring for heat decisions

— · 2024 · Database A;Database B

SCRIPT RECOMMENDATION

Include

Population and concept match

Abstract: "Fictional demonstration: urban heat monitoring, prediction and decision support for city planning"

Include 1

SCRIPT SUGGESTION

Population and concept match

Abstract: "Fictional demonstration: urban heat monitoring, prediction and decision support for city planning"

Maybe 2

Not the script suggestion

Exclude 3

Not the script suggestion

Exclusion code

—

Notes

Synthetic test decision only.

► Abstract & metadata

[Clear decision \(back to undecided\)](#)

Review mode: change Include/Maybe/Exclude anytime · J/K browse · S save

The navigation sidebar belongs to the search and screening stage. The same colours, type and controls continue into the evidence workspace.

Current interface edition | Screenshots, 28 September 2026. Fictional demonstration papers.

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Screen reference: paper review

Current toolkit. Categories, domains, source sections and evidence choices share one paper page.

Literature review toolkit

Paper review

Synthesis map

Classification: 0/1 · Extraction: 0/1

Export & help

Queue

Find paper

Domain

All papers

ID, title or author

All domains

1 papers · browse

TEST001 · EXTRACTION: UNREVIEWED · CLASSIFICATION: UNCLASSIFIED

Open PDF

Synthetic building review

Thermal simulation

Buildings

Abstract and conclusions · Python extraction

Evidence & synthesis

Categories & domains

Source search

Study evidence

My interpretation

Measured outcome *

Unchecked

Report the units and conditions.

Your concise summary, exact result or explanation...

Source pages

e.g. 4, Table 2

My reflection

Unchecked

Your interpretation or proposal...

Source pages

e.g. 4, Table 2

Reviewer

Your name

Not yet reviewed

Save draft

Later

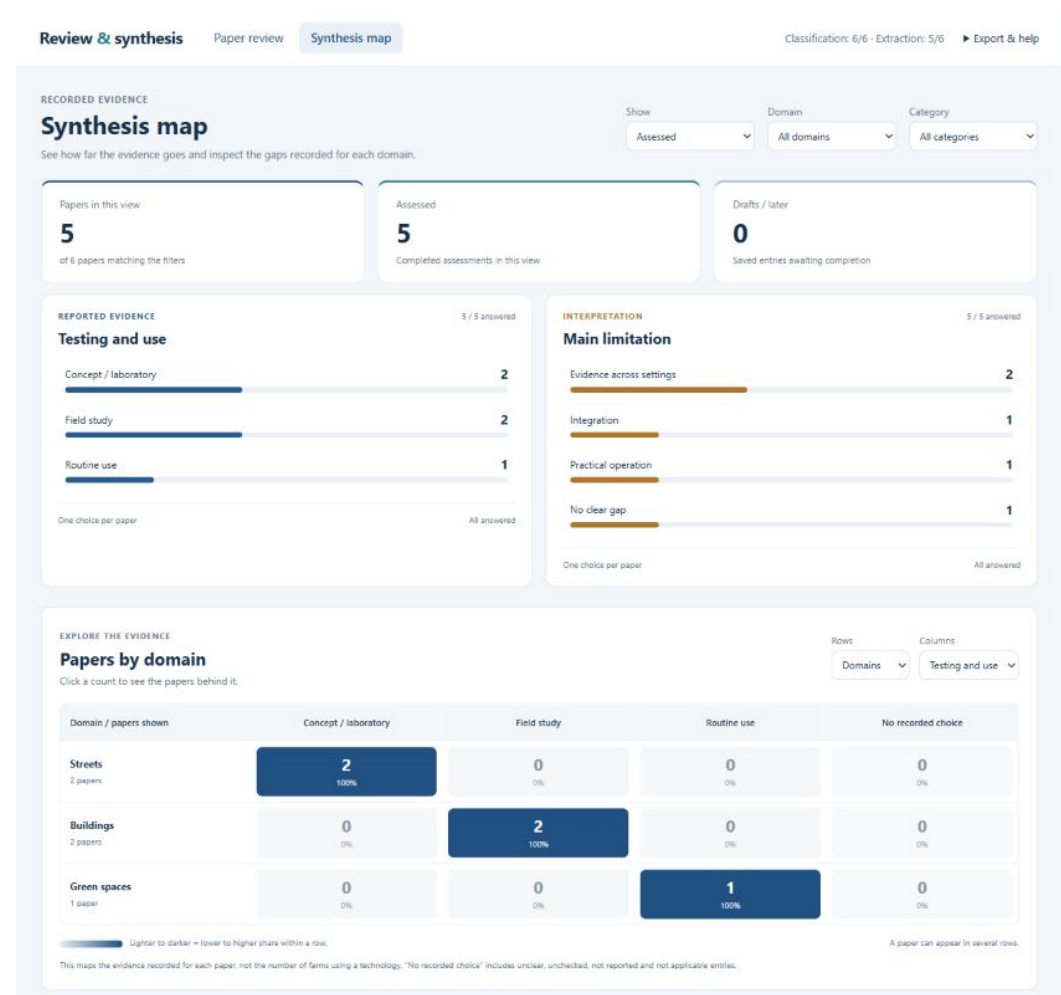
Confirm & next

Ctrl ↵

Switch between Categories & domains and Evidence & synthesis without changing papers. Open PDF and Source search stay available.

Screen reference: synthesis map

Current toolkit. Each bar or matrix count opens the contributing paper list.



The screenshot shows five completed fictional assessments; a draft remains outside the selected cohort. Your own field definitions determine the cards and matrix columns.

CSV records with a preserved history

A new review needs no SQL database. The interface remains the place to edit decisions.

What is saved

Classification, evidence, reading choices and domain notes are stored in CSV revision journals. Current-state CSVs are derived from that history. Extracted pages and detected sections are CSV too.

Settings, provider caches and browser transport files can remain JSON; they are not databases. `CSV_STORAGE.md` lists the files and their purposes.

Safe saves

Each save checks the previous revision and replaces its CSV atomically. A checksum detects damaged records. A previous-file backup is retained. Conflicting edits are rejected instead of overwriting newer work.

Internal CSV columns preserve lists, notes and missing values exactly. Do not edit these journals in a spreadsheet. Use the form, then export ordinary summary CSVs for analysis.

Move an older review to CSV

1. Stop the old review server. Keep a backup of the run and source files.
2. Choose Open saved review and select the old folder. The toolkit reads legacy SQLite/JSON files and creates a new sibling folder ending in `-csv`.
3. Compare record counts and representative forms. Resume the new folder; keep the original unchanged. Migration does not confirm decisions or change labels.
4. Use Export all review CSVs + history ZIP for run records and settings. Back up original exports and externally linked PDFs separately.

Use one computer at a time. Local file locks do not coordinate simultaneous edits through OneDrive or another sync service.

Share the same views without the server

The corpus explorer is a read-only export of the toolkit, with the CSV included.

Create the portable copy

In Export & help, select Export corpus explorer ZIP. Extract the ZIP and double-click Corpus explorer.html. It needs no Python, server, database or installation.

The page embeds the summary CSV and shares the actual paper-view, filter and synthesis code with the live toolkit. The accompanying assessments.csv and project-settings.json make its inputs visible.

Use the map

Filter the saved records, compare choices and click a cell to see its papers. Choose a paper to inspect its saved categories, domains, evidence values and page references.

Load CSV opens a newer export with the same schema. For a different review scheme, export a new browser from the configured toolkit.

What the snapshot includes

Included	Not in the summary
Saved labels, choices and states	Source PDFs and full quotations
Source-page references	Abstract and conclusion extracts
Interactive charts and paper lists	Full revision and verification history

Saved statuses are preserved. A missing category is not inferred as No. The snapshot cannot edit or confirm your review; return to the working toolkit for changes.

The standalone CSV adapter and chart logic were tested. File opening and clickable maps were checked in Edge; shared views were inspected in the live toolkit.